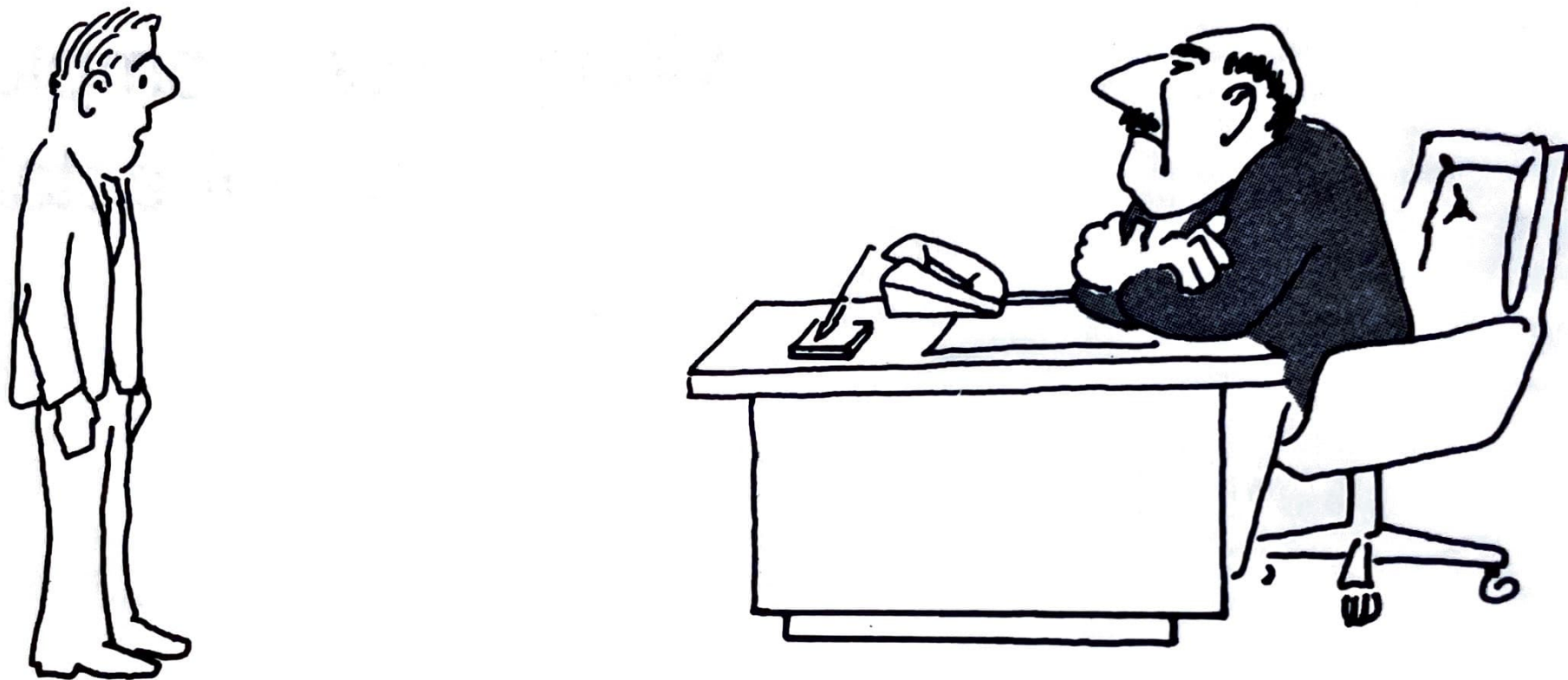
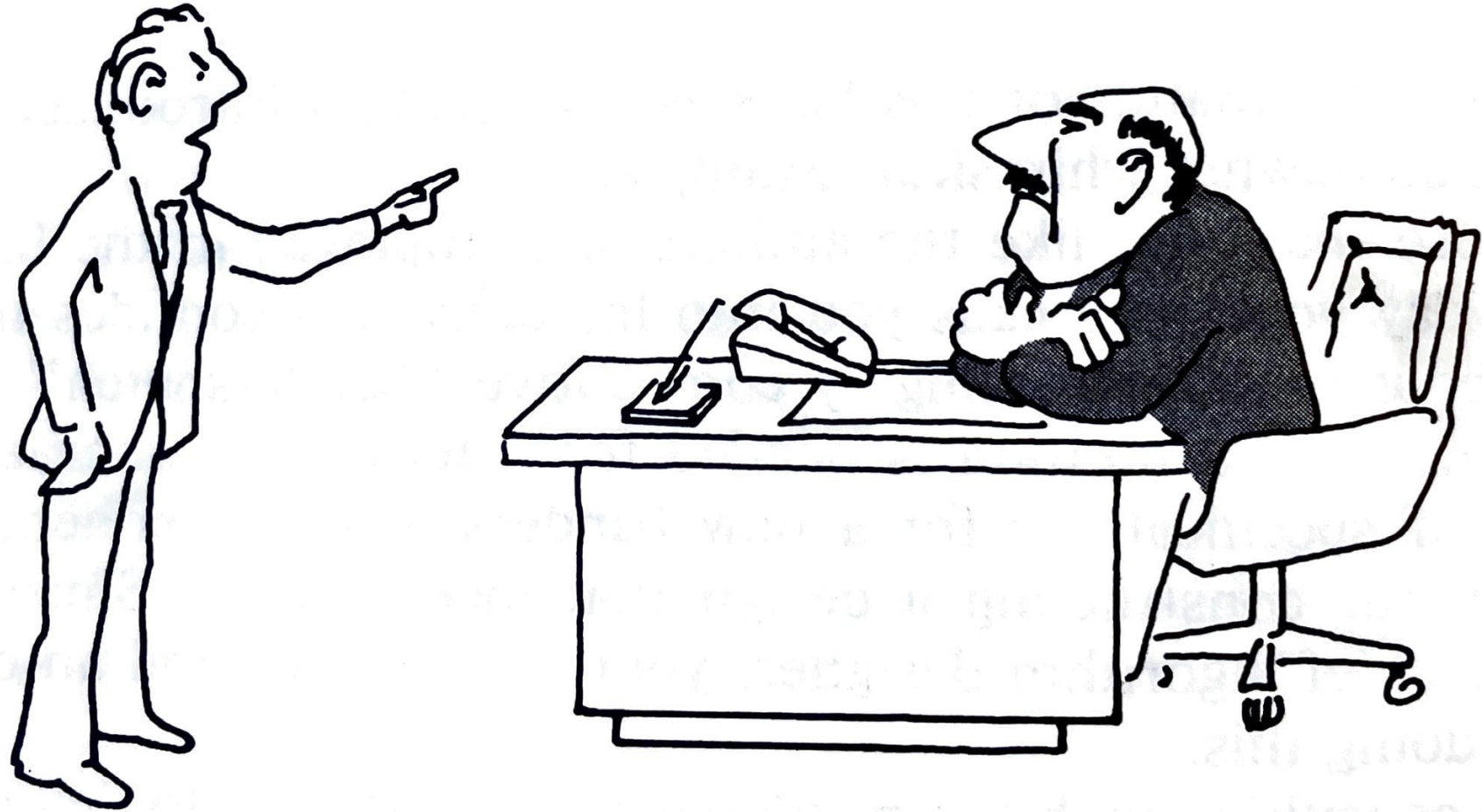




“I can’t find an efficient algorithm, I guess I’m just too dumb.”

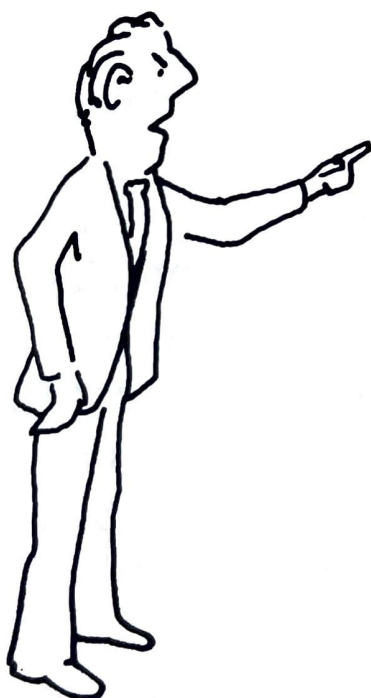


“I can’t find an efficient algorithm, because no such algorithm is possible!”



“I can’t find an efficient algorithm, I guess I’m just too dumb.”

To avoid serious damage to your position within the company, it would be much better if you could prove that the bandersnatch problem is inherently intractable, that no algorithm could possibly solve it quickly. You then could stride confidently into the boss’s office and proclaim:



“I can’t find an efficient algorithm, because no such algorithm is possible!”

Unfortunately, proving inherent intractability can be just as hard as finding an efficient algorithm. For example, the first algorithm for proving that a problem is intractable has been shown to require time that grows faster than any polynomial.



“I can’t find an efficient algorithm, but neither can all these famous people.”

COMPUTERS AND INTRACTABILITY

A Guide to the Theory of NP-Completeness

Michael R. Garey / David S. Johnson

